

Nouns and verbs

Learner workbook

Choose the form that fits a sentence.

Understand the distinction

A noun can name a thing, action, or idea; a verb tells what happens or describes a state. Some words have the same spelling in both roles: a plan / we plan. Other families change form: a decision / decide.

Look at the sentence pattern. An article such as a often comes before a noun phrase. A subject often needs a verb. Endings can help, but they are not reliable rules for every word. Check an unfamiliar word in a dictionary.

Compare the patterns

NOUN

We made a decision.

Decision names the result.

VERB

We decided to wait.

Decided is the past-tense verb.

BOTH

We plan to discuss the plan.

The first plan is a verb; the second is a noun.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. We need to ___ today. (decision / decide)

2. Please make a ___ . (choice / choose)

3. Identify the verb: They work at a school.

Use it in your own life

Use one word family in two sentences.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. decide

To is followed by the base verb in this pattern.

2. choice

A introduces a noun phrase.

3. work

Work tells what they do.

One possible response

We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-06.html